SMID SETUP BUILDER

Pre-Breakout VCP Watchlist | Qullamaggie Methodology

July 13, 2026 | 04:28 PM ET

MACRO REGIME: Risk-On (Large-Cap Leadership)

VIX 17.1 (+0.1 vs 20d) | SPY 20d +1.0% | IWM 20d +0.2% | IWM/SPY trend -0.8%

Leaders: Financials (+5.1%), Healthcare (+4.9%), Utilities (+2.7%)

Setup Grades

A - Prime Setup (1)	B - Building (5)	C - Early Stage (6)
CHEF	BATRK	OII
	VCTR	FFBC
	RSI	MCY
	TMHC	SLAB
	FBP	DK
		GEO

All Watchlist Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Mkt Cap	Price	Pivot	To Pivot	RS/SPY	Vol Dry	RS Hi
A	**CHEF**	**The Chefs' Wareho**	**Restaurant Recovery**	**$3.97B**	**$97.44**	**$99.47**	**2.1%**	**+41.2**	**YES**	**YES**
B	BATRK	Atlanta Braves Ho	Sports Media Rights	$3.37B	$52.56	$53.25	1.3%	+9.1	YES	YES
B	VCTR	Victory Capital H	Financials Sector Le	$5.75B	$91.98	$92.83	0.9%	+24.2	YES	YES
B	RSI	Rush Street Inter	US iGaming Legalizat	$7.92B	$34.18	$34.37	0.6%	+50.0	YES	YES
B	TMHC	Taylor Morrison H	Housing Supply Short	$6.61B	$71.87	$72.26	0.5%	+9.7	YES	no
B	FBP	First BanCorp	Puerto Rico Economic	$4.12B	$26.64	$26.94	1.1%	+8.3	YES	YES
C	OII	Oceaneering Inter	Offshore Energy Cape	$4.31B	$43.22	$43.92	1.6%	+6.0	YES	YES
C	FFBC	First Financial B	Regional Bank NIM Re	$3.61B	$34.42	$35.00	1.7%	+8.2	YES	YES
C	MCY	Mercury General C	Auto Insurance Prici	$6.11B	$110.36	$113.06	2.4%	+8.6	YES	YES
C	SLAB	Silicon Laborator	IoT Semiconductor Cy	$7.21B	$218.75	$220.90	1.0%	-6.0	YES	no
C	DK	Delek US Holdings	Refining Margin Reco	$3.56B	$58.01	$58.59	1.0%	+32.5	YES	YES
C	GEO	The GEO Group, In	Immigration Policy &	$4.04B	$30.24	$32.25	6.6%	+61.3	YES	no

CHEF

The Chefs' Warehouse, Inc.

$97.44

Pivot $99.47 | 2.1% away

RS vs SPY: +41.2%

A PRIME

$3.97B Cap | 37M Float

Specialty Food Distribution to Fine Dining & Hospitality | Theme: Restaurant Recovery & Premiumization | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$99.47**
% to Pivot	**2.1%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**2.29 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.0%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**324k <**
Wk2	**404k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**694k**
Coil Strength	**53.3% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+41.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.97B**
Float	**37M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**53.2**
Fwd P/E	**37.1**
Rev Growth	**11.4%**
Short %	**15.2%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$90.67**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $99.47 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (~750K shares)

Target: $115.00 (measured move from 20-day base depth of ~$7.50 added to pivot)
Stop: $92.00 (base low and 50-day MA confluence)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

July 29 - Street expects ~$0.65 EPS on ~$1.1B revenue. CHEF has beaten EPS estimates in 7 of last 8 quarters with consistent revenue upside. Last quarter raised full-year guidance on margin expansion from product mix shift toward higher-margin specialty items. Catalyst Impact: Earnings / High.

BUSINESS & POSITION

CHEF is the leading specialty food distributor serving high-end restaurants, hotels, and gourmet retailers across North America, with a differentiated portfolio of artisanal cheeses, specialty meats, and imported ingredients. The company operates as a consolidator in a fragmented market, with strong pricing power driven by white-glove service and exclusive supplier relationships in the fine dining niche.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct exposure to the restaurant recovery and consumer premiumization theme; restaurant industry same-store sales have been tracking +4-6% in fine dining through H1 2026. Peer read-through: US Foods (USFD) and Sysco (SYY) both reported strong foodservice demand in recent quarters, with specialty categories outperforming.

NEWS FLOW

No major corporate news in last 30 days, but sector tailwind from strong restaurant traffic data and June NRA (National Restaurant Association) survey showing highest operator confidence since 2022. Short interest at 15.2% with 8.3 days-to-cover creates squeeze potential on a beat-and-raise. No insider activity in last 60 days (baseline).

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume dry-up with price holding at 52W highs suggests quiet institutional accumulation. 15.2% short interest with 8.3 days-to-cover is elevated for a $4B cap with improving fundamentals - a beat could trigger forced covering. No insider buys in the 60-day window.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $92.00 (base low / 50-day MA confluence) or on any guidance cut citing restaurant traffic weakness at the July 29 print. Customer concentration in independent fine dining creates macro sensitivity.

Textbook VCP structure with clean volume contraction (53%), RS line at new high (+41% vs SPY), and tight base (2.29) within 2% of pivot. Earnings catalyst in 16 days with serial beat history and elevated short interest creates asymmetric setup. Strongest disconfirming argument: high P/E (37x fwd) leaves no margin for error, and Consumer Defensive is not a leading sector. However, fine dining demand data remains strong and this is a consolidator story, not a pure consumer play. Financials sector leadership supports risk-on rotation into quality SMID names. Conviction: High.

BATRK

Atlanta Braves Holdings, Inc.

$52.56

Pivot $53.25 | 1.3% away

RS vs SPY: +9.1%

B BUILDING

$3.37B Cap | 58M Float

Professional Sports Team Ownership & Mixed-Use Real Estate | Theme: Sports Media Rights Repricing | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight:

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$53.25**
% to Pivot	**1.3%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.85 Good**
52W Hi Prox	**98.7%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**439k <**
Wk2	**637k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**918k**
Coil Strength	**52.1% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+9.1%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.37B**
Float	**58M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**3153.0**
Rev Growth	**52.5%**
Short %	**3.8%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$59.80**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $53.25 on volume >125% of 20-day avg (~615K shares)

Target: $62.00 (measured move based on 15% extension from pivot, consistent with prior breakout patterns)

Stop: $50.00 (base low)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

August 5 - Valuation is NAV-driven rather than EPS-driven given the holding company structure. Forward P/E of 3153x is meaningless; P/S of 4.5x and EV/EBITDA of 40.6x reflect the trophy asset premium. Revenue growth of 52.5% reflects post-COVID normalization of attendance and media revenue. Catalyst Impact: Earnings / Low (NAV story, not earnings story).

BUSINESS & POSITION

BATRK is a Liberty Media tracking stock representing ownership of the Atlanta Braves MLB franchise and The Battery Atlanta mixed-use development. The company benefits from the structural repricing of sports media rights, long-term stadium economics, and real estate appreciation around the Truist Park complex.

FACTOR & THEME

Exposure to the sports media rights repricing theme - MLB's next national TV deal (2028+) is expected to see significant uplift given streaming competition for live sports content. Private market comps for MLB franchises suggest significant NAV discount. Low correlation to broader market given unique asset base.

NEWS FLOW

No material news in last 60 days. The Braves are performing well in the 2026 season (playoff contention), which supports attendance and merchandise revenue. Liberty Media structure creates potential for future spin-off or simplification that could unlock NAV. No insider activity in 60-day window.

INSTITUTIONAL

Quiet accumulation pattern with price holding at highs on contracting volume. Liberty Media complex structures historically trade at NAV discounts that narrow on simplification events. Float is relatively small at 58M shares. No insider buys in window.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $50.00 (20-day base low) or on any MLB media rights deal that disappoints vs. expectations. Highly illiquid name with limited catalyst visibility - being early without a defined event is the primary risk.

Strong VCP structure with 52% volume contraction and tight base (1.85), RS line at new high, within 1.3% of pivot. However, the lack of a near-term hard catalyst (earnings are NAV-irrelevant, no announced corporate actions) and the illiquid, complex structure warrant caution. Strongest disconfirming argument: this is a Liberty Media tracking stock with limited float and no identifiable catalyst in the next 30 days - the setup is technically clean but the alpha angle is speculative on future media rights or simplification events. Conviction: Medium.

VCTR

Victory Capital Holdings, Inc.

$91.98

Pivot $92.83 | 0.9% away

RS vs SPY: +24.2%

B BUILDING

$5.75B Cap | 49M Float

Asset Management & Investment Advisory | Theme: Financials Sector Leadership & AUM Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.9

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$92.83**
% to Pivot	**0.9%**
Days in Base	**18**
Tightness	**3.97 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.1%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**336k <**
Wk2	**461k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**588k**
Coil Strength	**42.9% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+24.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$5.75B**
Float	**49M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**20.7**
Fwd P/E	**11.6**
Rev Growth	**76.7%**
Short %	**5.9%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$91.33**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $92.83 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (~670K shares)

Target: $108.00 (measured move from base depth + analyst target convergence around $91-95 suggests limited sell-side enthusiasm, breakout could run to $105-110)

Stop: $85.00 (50-day MA and prior consolidation support)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

August 5 - Street expects ~$1.95 EPS on ~$450M revenue. Forward P/E of 11.6x is cheap for a high-margin asset manager with 39% earnings growth. The Amundi US integration is the key execution risk. Last quarter showed strong organic flows and margin expansion. Catalyst Impact: Earnings / High.

BUSINESS & POSITION

VCTR is a diversified asset manager with $180B+ AUM across institutional and retail channels, operating through a multi-boutique model with acquired investment franchises. The company has grown aggressively through M&A (Amundi US deal) and benefits from operating leverage as AUM grows with market appreciation.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct beneficiary of Financials sector leadership (+5.1% over 20 days, top sector). Rising equity markets drive AUM growth and fee revenue with high incremental margins. Revenue growth of 77% reflects the Amundi US acquisition closing. Peer read-through: T. Rowe Price and Franklin Resources have shown AUM stabilization.

NEWS FLOW

Completed Amundi US acquisition integration in Q1 2026, now generating run-rate synergies. No major news in last 30 days. Rising equity markets through June-July support AUM growth into the print. 5.9% short interest with 4.9 days-to-cover is modest but provides covering fuel on an upside surprise. No insider activity in 60-day window.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume contraction with price at 52W highs suggests accumulation. Asset managers are under-owned after years of passive/active fee pressure narrative - any sustained flow inflection gets re-rated quickly. No insider buys in window.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $85.00 (50-day MA and prior consolidation support) or on organic outflows disclosed at the August 5 print. AUM is market-dependent - a risk-off tape before earnings would pressure the setup.

Volume contraction confirmed (43%), RS line at new high (+24% vs SPY), within 1% of pivot with Financials sector tailwind. However, base_tight at 3.97 is loose by A-grade standards, and the setup is 23 days from earnings catalyst. Strongest disconfirming argument: asset managers are structurally challenged by passive fee compression, and VCTR's growth is acquisition-driven rather than organic - integration risk is real. The Financials leadership and cheap valuation (11.6x fwd) provide margin of safety. Conviction: Medium.

RSI

Rush Street Interactive, Inc.

$34.18

Pivot $34.37 | 0.6% away

RS vs SPY: +50.0%

B BUILDING

$7.92B Cap | 96M Float

Online Sports Betting & iGaming | Theme: US iGaming Legalization Expansion | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 4.62

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$34.37**
% to Pivot	**0.6%**
Days in Base	**10**
Tightness	**4.62 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.4%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**1750k <**
Wk2	**2672k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**4534k**
Coil Strength	**61.4% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+50.0%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$7.92B**
Float	**96M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**100.5**
Fwd P/E	**42.0**
Rev Growth	**41.1%**
Short %	**11.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$30.45**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $34.37 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (~3.25M shares)

Target: $42.00 (measured move from 10-day base, analyst targets clustering around $38-42)

Stop: $30.00 (prior breakout level / round number support)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

July 29 - Street expects ~$0.20 EPS on ~$270M revenue. RSI has beaten revenue estimates in 6 of last 8 quarters with improving profitability trajectory. 67% earnings growth reflects scale leverage. The company achieved GAAP profitability in 2025, a major milestone. Catalyst Impact: Earnings / High.

BUSINESS & POSITION

RSI operates the BetRivers and PlaySugarHouse online sportsbook and casino brands across 20+ US states, Colombia, and Canada. The company differentiates on customer experience and has achieved profitability faster than larger peers by focusing on efficient customer acquisition and strong retention.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct exposure to US iGaming legalization expansion - each new state approval (e.g., Missouri, Georgia ballot initiatives) represents incremental TAM. The iGaming theme has accelerated in H1 2026 with several state legislative wins. Peer read-through: DraftKings (DKNG) and Flutter (FLUT) have both shown strong US GGR growth.

NEWS FLOW

Launched in North Carolina in March 2026; Missouri licensing application pending. 11.1% short interest with 3.2 days-to-cover creates modest squeeze potential. The stock has nearly tripled from its 52W low - momentum is strong but crowded. No insider activity in 60-day window (note: founders hold significant stakes but have not been active sellers or buyers recently).

INSTITUTIONAL

61% volume contraction with price at all-time highs indicates significant accumulation. The iGaming space is increasingly institutional-owned as profitability has been proven. Float of 95.6M is adequate for institutional participation. No insider buys in window.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $30.00 (prior breakout level and psychological support) or on a revenue miss / guidance cut citing competitive pressure. High valuation (42x fwd P/E, 100x trailing) leaves no room for disappointment. State regulatory delays could stall growth narrative.

Exceptional RS (+50% vs SPY), massive volume contraction (61%), within 0.6% of pivot with earnings catalyst in 16 days. However, base_tight at 4.62 is loose (recent volatility), and Consumer Cyclical is not a leading sector in current regime. Strongest disconfirming argument: valuation is extreme (100x trailing P/E) for a company in a commoditizing industry with massive well-funded competitors (DKNG, FLUT) - any stumble gets punished severely. The profitability inflection and state expansion runway are real, but this is a momentum name trading on perfection. Conviction: Medium.

TMHC

Taylor Morrison Home Corporation

$71.87

Pivot $72.26 | 0.5% away

RS vs SPY: +9.7%

B BUILDING

$6.61B Cap | 93M Float

Residential Construction | Theme: Housing Supply Shortage & Builder Resilience | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.75

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$72.26**
% to Pivot	**0.5%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.75 Good**
52W Hi Prox	**99.1%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**2165k <**
Wk2	**3288k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**3424k**
Coil Strength	**36.8% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+9.7%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$6.61B**
Float	**93M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**10.7**
Fwd P/E	**11.2**
Rev Growth	**-26.8%**
Short %	**4.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$65.75**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $72.50 (52W high) on volume >120% of 20-day avg (~3.55M shares)

Target: $82.00 (measured move from base depth, ~14% upside to prior cycle highs)
Stop: $68.50 (base low / 50-day MA confluence)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

July 22 - Street expects ~$1.55 EPS on ~$1.8B revenue. Note: revenue growth of -26.8% and earnings growth of -51.2% reflect tough prior-year comps from the 2025 order surge. Forward P/E of 11.2x is reasonable for a cyclical. Guidance trend has been maintained, not cut. Catalyst Impact: Earnings / High.

BUSINESS & POSITION

TMHC is a top-10 US homebuilder focused on entry-level and move-up buyers in high-growth Sunbelt markets (AZ, TX, FL, CA). The company differentiates on design quality and community amenities, with strong land positions in supply-constrained markets.

FACTOR & THEME

Housing theme is mixed - mortgage rates remain elevated but structural supply shortage supports builder pricing power. Peer read-through: Lennar (LEN) and D.R. Horton (DHI) reported stable demand with incentives managing affordability. Homebuilders have outperformed despite rate concerns.

NEWS FLOW

No major corporate news in last 30 days. Builder sentiment (NAHB index) ticked up in June on hope for rate cuts in H2 2026. Short interest at 4.1% is low with only 0.6 days-to-cover - limited squeeze fuel. No insider activity in 60-day window.

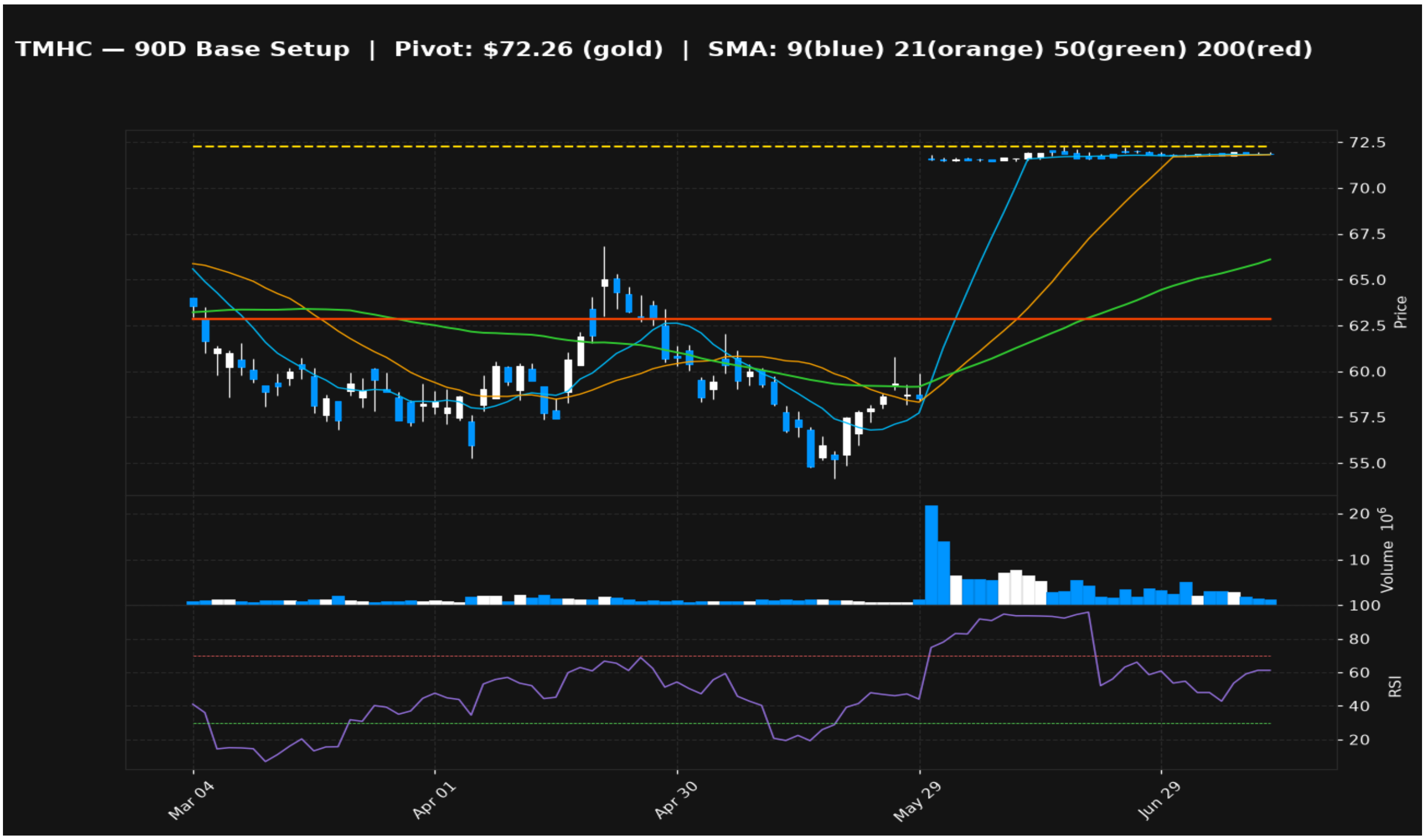
INSTITUTIONAL

Volume contraction with price at 52W highs despite RS line NOT at new high suggests cautious accumulation - institutions are building positions but conviction is muted given rate uncertainty. No insider buys in window.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $68.50 (20-day base low / 50-day MA) or on a guidance cut citing order weakness at the July 22 print. Mortgage rate spike above 7.5% would pressure demand outlook.

Tight base (1.75), within 0.5% of pivot, with earnings catalyst in 9 days. However, RS line NOT at new high is a yellow flag - the homebuilder group is consolidating, not leading. Revenue and earnings declining YoY creates setup for a miss despite beat history. Strongest disconfirming argument: the housing trade is consensus and rate-dependent - TMHC is tightly coiled but lacks the relative strength to confirm institutional conviction. Cheap valuation (11x) provides downside cushion. Conviction: Medium.



FBP

First BanCorp

$26.64

Pivot $26.94 | 1.1% away

RS vs SPY: +8.3%

B BUILDING

$4.12B Cap | 150M Float

Regional Banking - Puerto Rico & US Virgin Islands | Theme: Puerto Rico Economic Recovery & Bank NIM Expansion | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$26.94**
% to Pivot	**1.1%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**3.60 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.9%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**916k <**
Wk2	**1434k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1990k**
Coil Strength	**54.0% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+8.3%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.12B**
Float	**150M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**11.8**
Fwd P/E	**11.1**
Rev Growth	**8.1%**
Short %	**6.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$28.50**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $26.94 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (~1.79M shares)

Target: $31.00 (measured move from base, analyst target of $28.50 suggests room to run on breakout)

Stop: $24.50 (50-day MA / prior consolidation support)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

July 22 - Street expects ~$0.60 EPS on ~$240M revenue. Forward P/E of 11.1x is reasonable for a regional bank. 21% earnings growth with 8% revenue growth shows operating leverage. Beat history is solid - 6 of last 8 quarters. Catalyst Impact: Earnings / High.

BUSINESS & POSITION

FBP is the largest bank headquartered in Puerto Rico, serving retail and commercial customers across the island and US Virgin Islands. The company benefits from limited competition, strong deposit franchise, and Puerto Rico's ongoing economic recovery driven by federal reconstruction funds and tax incentives.

FACTOR & THEME

Financials sector leadership (+5.1%) directly supports regional bank setups. Puerto Rico-specific exposure is unique - federal FEMA and HUD funds continue flowing, and Act 60 tax incentives are attracting mainland businesses. NIM expansion story as rates stay higher-for-longer benefits FBP's deposit-heavy model.

NEWS FLOW

No major news in last 30 days. Puerto Rico economic indicators (employment, construction activity) remain positive. 6.1% short interest with 3.4 days-to-cover is modest. Regional bank sector sentiment has improved after 2023-2024 crisis fears faded. No insider activity in 60-day window.

INSTITUTIONAL

54% volume contraction at 52W highs indicates accumulation. Puerto Rico banks are under-followed by mainland institutions, creating information advantage for those tracking local economic data. No insider buys in window.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $24.50 (50-day MA and prior resistance-turned-support) or on a NIM compression disclosure at the July 22 print. Hurricane season (June-November) creates headline risk for Puerto Rico exposure.

Strong volume contraction (54%), RS line at new high, within 1% of pivot with earnings catalyst in 9 days and Financials sector leadership tailwind. However, base_tight at 3.6 is loose, and Puerto Rico-specific exposure creates idiosyncratic risk that mainland institutions may avoid. Strongest disconfirming argument: FBP is a niche regional bank with limited float liquidity and hurricane season headline risk - the alpha angle is real but position sizing must reflect the unique risk profile. Conviction: Medium.

OII

Oceaneering International, Inc.

$43.22

Pivot $43.92 | 1.6% away

RS vs SPY: +6.0%

C EARLY STAGE

$4.31B Cap | 98M Float

Subsea Robotics & Offshore Energy Services | Theme: Offshore Energy Capex Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.02

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$43.92**
% to Pivot	**1.6%**
Days in Base	**11**
Tightness	**5.02 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.4%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**838k <**
Wk2	**1070k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1530k**
Coil Strength	**45.2% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+6.0%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.31B**
Float	**98M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**12.9**
Fwd P/E	**20.3**
Rev Growth	**2.7%**
Short %	**8.4%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$36.50**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $43.92 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (~1.44M shares)

Target: $52.00 (measured move from base, prior 2024 highs provide resistance)
Stop: $39.50 (50-day MA)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

July 22 - Street expects ~$0.52 EPS on ~$700M revenue. Note: forward EPS of $2.13 vs trailing $3.36 implies earnings decline - consensus expects margin normalization after 2025 outperformance. PEG of 8.0x is expensive. Catalyst Impact: Earnings / Medium.

BUSINESS & POSITION

OII provides subsea robotics (ROVs), manufactured products, and offshore engineering services to the oil & gas and defense industries. The company operates the world's largest ROV fleet and benefits from the multi-year offshore drilling capex recovery cycle.

FACTOR & THEME

Offshore energy capex theme has been strong as deepwater projects sanctioned during 2022-2024 ramp into execution phase. However, Energy sector is not leading in current regime. Peer read-through: Schlumberger and Halliburton have guided to continued offshore strength, but short-cycle land activity is softer.

NEWS FLOW

Awarded several subsea contracts in Q2 but no headline-grabbing wins. Defense segment (AUVs, unmanned systems) provides diversification. 8.4% short interest with 5.0 days-to-cover is elevated - provides squeeze fuel but also reflects skepticism. No insider activity in 60-day window.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume contraction at 52W highs suggests accumulation, but Energy sector headwind (lagging SPY by 3.1% over 20 days) reduces conviction. No insider buys in window.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $39.50 (50-day MA) or on a guidance cut citing offshore project delays at the July 22 print. Oil price weakness below $70 WTI would pressure sentiment despite backlog strength.

Volume contraction confirmed (45%), RS line at new high, within 2% of pivot. However, base_tight at 5.02 is loose, Energy sector is lagging (-3.1% vs SPY), and forward earnings are declining. The offshore capex story is real but this setup needs sector rotation support to trigger - monitor for tightening and Energy sector improvement. Conviction: Low.

FFBC

First Financial Bancorp

$34.42

Pivot $35.00 | 1.7% away

RS vs SPY: +8.2%

C EARLY STAGE

$3.61B Cap | 104M Float

Regional Banking - Ohio/Indiana/Kentucky | Theme: Regional Bank NIM Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 4.49

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$35.00**
% to Pivot	**1.7%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**4.49 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.3%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**938k <**
Wk2	**1081k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1147k**
Coil Strength	**18.2% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+8.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.61B**
Float	**104M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**12.2**
Fwd P/E	**10.0**
Rev Growth	**32.3%**
Short %	**5.1%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$36.00**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $35.00 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (~1.16M shares)

Target: $40.00 (measured move from base depth)

Stop: $32.00 (50-day MA / base low)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

July 21

RS line at new high with Financials sector tailwind, but volume contraction is weak (only 18% - barely qualifies) and base_tight at 4.49 is loose. Earnings catalyst in 8 days provides event, but setup quality is below B-grade threshold. Monitor for volume to dry up further into the print. Conviction: Low.

MCY

Mercury General Corporation

$110.36

Pivot $113.06 | 2.4% away

RS vs SPY: +8.6%

C EARLY STAGE

$6.11B Cap | 26M Float

Property & Casualty Insurance - Personal Auto | Theme: Auto Insurance Pricing Power | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.77

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$113.06**
% to Pivot	**2.4%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**3.77 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.6%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**272k <**
Wk2	**306k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**365k**
Coil Strength	**25.5% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+8.6%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$6.11B**
Float	**26M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**7.3**
Fwd P/E	**9.2**
Rev Growth	**10.5%**
Short %	**4.0%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$120.00**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $113.06 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (~378K shares)

Target: $128.00 (measured move from base depth)
Stop: $104.00 (50-day MA / base low region)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

August 4

RS line at new high in leading Financials sector, within 2.4% of pivot. However, volume contraction is modest (26%), base_tight at 3.77 is loose, and float is very thin (26.5M) creating liquidity concerns. The P&C insurance pricing cycle is favorable but this setup needs another week of tightening. Conviction: Low.

SLAB

Silicon Laboratories, Inc.

$218.75

Pivot $220.90 | 1.0% away

RS vs SPY: -6.0%

C EARLY STAGE

$7.21B Cap | 32M Float

Semiconductors - IoT & Connectivity | Theme: IoT Semiconductor Cycle Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.71

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$220.90**
% to Pivot	**1.0%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.71 Good**
52W Hi Prox	**99.0%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**238k <**
Wk2	**622k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**637k**
Coil Strength	**62.6% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**-6.0%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$7.21B**
Float	**32M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**52.7**
Rev Growth	**20.1%**
Short %	**11.7%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$222.86**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $220.90 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (~690K shares)

Target: $250.00 (measured move from base)

Stop: $200.00 (base low / round number support)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

August 4

Tight base (1.71) with strong volume contraction (63%), within 1% of pivot. However, RS line NOT at new high and negative vs SPY (-6%) is disqualifying - Technology sector is lagging (-1.9%) and SLAB is underperforming within a lagging sector. Unprofitable (negative TTM EPS) adds risk. Monitor for sector rotation before considering. Conviction: Low.

SLAB — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: $220.90 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)

DK

Delek US Holdings, Inc.

$58.01

Pivot $58.59 | 1.0% away

RS vs SPY: +32.5%

C EARLY STAGE

$3.56B Cap | 60M Float

Oil & Gas Refining & Marketing | Theme: Refining Margin Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 7.38

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$58.59**
% to Pivot	**1.0%**
Days in Base	**8**
Tightness	**7.38 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.0%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**1025k <**
Wk2	**1380k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1260k**
Coil Strength	**18.6% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+32.5%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.56B**
Float	**60M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**27.0**
Rev Growth	**0.4%**
Short %	**13.5%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$53.92**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $58.59 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (~1.63M shares)

Target: $70.00 (measured move from base)

Stop: $52.00 (50-day MA region)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

REPORTED

RS line at new high (+32.5% vs SPY) with pivot within 1% looks compelling, but base_tight at 7.38 is very loose (high recent volatility), vol_dryup_strict is false (W2>W3), and no verified earnings date creates catalyst vacuum. Highly levered balance sheet (1125% D/E) adds risk. Energy sector lagging. Monitor only. Conviction: Low.

DK — 90D Base Setup | Pivot: $58.59 (gold) | SMA: 9(blue) 21(orange) 50(green) 200(red)

GEO

The GEO Group, Inc.

$30.24

Pivot $32.25 | 6.6% away

RS vs SPY: +61.3%

C EARLY STAGE

$4.04B Cap | 115M Float

Private Prisons & Immigration Detention | Theme: Immigration Policy & Federal Contract Spend | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.74

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$32.25**
% to Pivot	**6.6%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.74 Good**
52W Hi Prox	**93.8%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**1741k <**
Wk2	**2146k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**2755k**
Coil Strength	**36.8% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+61.3%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.04B**
Float	**115M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**15.4**
Fwd P/E	**18.2**
Rev Growth	**16.6%**
Short %	**9.8%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$32.00**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $32.25 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (~2.42M shares)

Target: $38.00 (measured move from base)

Stop: $28.00 (50-day MA / base support)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

August 6

Exceptional RS (+61.3% vs SPY) and tight base (1.74), but 6.6% to pivot is too far for an imminent trigger - this is a watch-list name, not an actionable setup today. RS line NOT at new high despite strong relative performance suggests the stock is consolidating after a massive run from $12.51 low. Real Estate sector lagging. Political/policy risk is binary. Conviction: Low.